DIABETES DISABILITY Mini -DBQ (Disability Benefits Questionnaire)

Please answer the following questions regarding the current severity of your Service-Connected (s/c) Diabetes and its complications: (*It is also encouraged to submit any recent treatment for your diabetes with this Mini-DBQ)*

CURRENT DIABETES TREATMENT: *(Check all that apply)*

☐	Managed by a restricted diet ***(10 percent)***	☐	Prescribed Insulin, 1 injection per day ***(20 percent)***
☐	Prescribed Oral Hypoglycemic Agent *(i.e., Metformin)* ***(20 percent)***	☐	Prescribed Insulin, More than 1 injection per day ***(20 percent)***

How frequent do you visit your doctor for diabetes for ketoacidosis or hypoglycemic reactions?

☐ less than 2 times per month	☐ 2 times per month	☐ 3 or more times per month

How many episodes of ketoacidosis require hospitalizations over the past 12 months?

☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3 or more

How many episodes of hypoglycemia requires hospitalization over the past 12 months?

☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3 or more

Weight loss – have you had unintentional weight loss since you have been diagnosed with diabetes?

☐ **Yes** ☐ **No**

What was your weight before? _____

What is your weight now? _____

Have you had progressive loss of strength that is attributable to diabetes? If yes How? Otherwise skip.

In your own words, how does Diabetes and its complications affect your daily life and ability to work:

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Briefly describe history (how the disability began):

Please describe any other possible conditions as a result of your diabetes and/or any other notes you feel should be included:

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PERIPHERAL NEUROPATHY DUE TO DIABETES MELLITUS

Also described as sciatica; nerve issues; and/or radiating/shooting pain down legs/arms

Symptxoms of peripheral neuropathy are very common with Veterans diagnosed with Diabetes Mellitus, and you may be eligible for additional ratings for each extremity (arm/leg). ***Please note: if you already have a rating for your legs of nerve issues secondary to a service-connected back condition you cannot get a separate rating due to peripheral neuropathy in your legs as a result of service-connected diabetes.***

Common symptoms *are:* ***1)*** *numbness and/or tingling sensation anywhere in your legs or arms, and/or* ***2)*** *loss of feeling in fingers or toes, and/or* ***3)*** *shooting pain down your legs*

- ***Mild symptoms***: Does NOT really interfere with activities of daily living (ADLs), only minor issues that you occasionally notice ***(10% each leg, 20% each arm)***
- ***Moderate symptoms***: DOES affect ADLs; more constant and painful and/or weakened movement that is noticeable daily ***(20% each leg, up to 40 percent for your dominant arm & 30 percent for non-dominant arm)***

DO YOU EVER EXPERIENCE ANY SYMPTOMS OF PERIPHERAL NEUROPATHY?

(Even if it's intermittently and only occurs with certain movements or activities)

	Yes, MILD symptoms *(Up to 10 percent each leg, up to 20 percent each arm) Check all that apply*						
☐	Right Leg	☐	Left Leg	☐	Right Arm	☐	Left Arm

☐	**Yes, MODERATE symptoms *(Up to 20 percent each leg, up to 40 for dominant arm) Check all that apply***						
☐	Right Leg	☐	Left Leg	☐	Right Arm	☐	Left Arm
☐	**NO**, I do NOT have symptoms of peripheral neuropathy						

ERECTILE DYSFUNCTION: Do you have it as a result of your service-connected diabetes?

☐	Yes, I am prescribed: (List medications below)
☐	Yes, but I am not prescribed medication.
☐	No, I do not have erectile dysfunction AND/OR it is due to a separate disability

CERTIFICATION - To the best of my knowledge, the information contained herein is accurate, complete and current. I understand that overstating the severity of my conditions on official Disability Benefits Questionnaires (DBQs) could result in loss of benefits and/or be consider fraudulent. I am conveying the severity of my symptoms to the best of my ability on this personal assessment form. No one has advised me to misrepresent my conditions or overstate the severity of my symptoms.